

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Questionable licenses and truant uninstallers—all dealt with right here!

When U're Hit...

Q While I was installing a game, a program named WhenUSave got installed on my computer. Now when I start my computer, it appears immediately on screen and starts connecting, and asks me to have patience as if it is trying to install something. The computer gets very slow. If I switch over to another user it hangs.

Satish Chandra

A WhenUSave is adware that installs with many free software, but it usually gives you the choice to install it or not. It can be easily removed using a spyware removal software such as Spybot—Search & Destroy (version 1.4.0) from www.safer-networking.org. Spybot is free-ware, and you'll find it on this month's CD.

It's The Drivers Again

Q I have two 250 GB Seagate hard drives and I want to set them up in a RAID configuration. When I try to install XP on them, they aren't detected during the installation. What could be the problem?

Aneesh Jagtiani

A We're assuming you've already set up your computer in a RAID configuration. XP setup needs to be provided the RAID drivers to be able to detect the hard drives in this configuration. When you run the XP installation, press [F6] at the start at the point you see Press F6 if you need to install a third-party SCSI or RAID driver (at the bottom of the screen). Keep ready a clean floppy with the drivers copied in the root. You can find these drivers at the manufacturer's Web site. Select from the list of devices enumerated in the next screen (usually the first). Press [Enter] and continue. Your drive will be detected, and you can proceed with the XP installation.

Power Play

Q I have an external USB 2.0 hard drive that works very well on my Desktop PC. But when I connect it to my laptop, it does not work.

Binu Mathias

A Windows XP can still find it tricky to deal with USB devices that aren't keyboards, mice, or printers. The external USB drive may not be receiving enough power to initialise, so try the following. Open the Device Manager by running `devmgmt.msc`. Open the Universal Serial Bus controllers tree and double-click on all the USB Root Hub entries. There should be two or more such entries. Click on the Power Management tab for each one and remove any check-mark in the box that has Allow the computer to turn off this device to save power next to it. Then disconnect the drive, restart Windows, and connect the drive. If doing that doesn't work, the drive may have come with a USB-to-5V cable, which you should use; it provides extra power. If it's not come with the drive, you can purchase one for Rs 100.

Doing Me A Disservice!

Q I recently installed a program after which Windows XP refuses to boot. I have searched on the Internet and found that this particular program installs a service at startup and causes the problem. But I have not been able to find a solution. I know the name of the service but am not able to disable it, because I cannot boot at all. I use Windows 2000 Server.

Atul Shrivastav

A To disable the offending service, start your computer with the Windows boot disks, or with the Windows installation CD-ROM if your computer supports booting from the CD drive. When the Welcome to Setup dialog box is displayed, press [R] to repair when prompted to do so. Then press [C] to start the Recovery Console. Choose to install Windows and log on to your computer using your Administrator account. From the `%SystemRoot%\System32` folder at the command prompt, type `listsvc` and press [Enter]. Since you know the name of the offending service, locate the service or driver that is causing the problem in the provided list. Note that selecting the wrong service or device could cause further problems. Type `disable servicename` where `servicename` is the name of the service, and press [Enter]. Note that the `disable` command displays the old `start_type` of the service before resetting it to `SERVICE_DISABLED`. You should note down the old `start_type`, just in case you need to re-enable the service. Type `exit`, and the computer will restart automatically. You should now be able to boot normally.

Let There Be Light!

Q When I Open the User Accounts in the Control Panel in XP Professional, I do not see the Administrator account in the list. I need to change the password for the Administrator account.

Ritesh Chakraborty

A The Administrator account is normally visible in the Normal mode booting of Windows XP only if there is no other user account, but is always visible in Safe Mode. To work around your problem in Normal mode, follow the following steps.



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!